

Kaden Huynh

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Education

University of California, Santa Barbara

Bachelor of Arts (B.A.) in Political Science, Minor in Philosophy

Santa Barbara, CA

Sep 2024 - Jun 2027

- Cumulative GPA: 3.87/4.0 | Honors: Dean's Honor List, National Political Science Honor Society
- Relevant Coursework: Political Theory (Classical, Modern, Contemporary)

Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona, UCEAP

Barcelona, Spain

Jun 2026 - Aug 2026

- Relevant Coursework: Leadership and Negotiation Techniques, Critical Thinking

Experience

Pho Ha Grill & Bar

Oceanside, CA

Shift Lead

Dec 2021 – Dec 2025

- Supervised a team of 10+ employees in a fast-paced, customer-oriented environment, developing leadership and operational management qualities while handling thousands of dollars in sales transactions each shift.
- Onboarded 5 new employees on workplace procedures, improving communication and team coordination skills.
- Analyzed metrics across Grubhub, DoorDash, and Uber Eats to identify inefficiencies, implementing UI changes and optimizations that increased online orders by 25%, strengthening data analysis and technical skills.

In-N-Out

San Diego, CA

Associate

Dec 2023 – Aug 2024

- Collaborated with a team of over 30 employees across simultaneous high-volume stations, adapting quickly to shifting operational demands and maintaining efficiency during peak service periods throughout the week.
- Delivered professional service to hundreds of customers per shift while maintaining composure and efficiency.

Leadership & Activities

Vietnamese Buddhist Youth Association

San Diego, CA

Youth Leader

May 2019 - Present

- Spearheaded community fundraising campaigns through prayers and banquets, generating thousands of dollars in direct relief aid for flood victims across Vietnam and supporting international humanitarian efforts.
- Planned and executed summer camps and weekly meetings for 60+ members, building project management and organizational skills while fostering a sense of community and belonging among youth participants.

National Speech & Debate Association

San Diego, CA

Parliamentary Debater

Aug 2020 - Jun 2024

- Competed in Parliamentary Debate at tournaments across California, earning a varsity performance award against hundreds of peers while building advanced argumentation, public speaking, and case-analysis skills.
- Researched, synthesized sources, and drafted written cases on rotating resolutions across policy, international relations, and ethics, analyzing unfamiliar issues and refuting complex arguments under time pressure.

Projects

Legal CRM

Jun 2026

Web Application | JavaScript, Supabase, Claude API, Google Workspace

- Built a personal legal-networking CRM with a searchable contact directory, built-in Gmail inbox, and calendar-based follow-up scheduling to manage relationships with attorneys, judges, and mentors in one place.
- Used AI to turn meeting notes into organized contact records and to draft contextualized outreach emails based on each recipient's role and history, cutting the manual work of logging contacts and writing correspondence.

Athena

May 2026

Web Application | React, Node.js, Supabase, Claude API, Mapbox

- Built an application that ingests short-form media, web links, and PDFs and uses a Claude API tool call to transcribe, summarize, and classify each item, with a review queue to correct low-confidence results.
- Architected a system to condense large volumes of source material and media into key points, organizing them in a searchable archive for quick retrieval, and mapping referenced locations for visual context.

Skills & Interests

Awards: AP Scholar with Distinction, Seal of Biliteracy in Spanish, SDIVSL Varsity Parliamentary Award

Languages: Fluent in English and Spanish, Proficient in Vietnamese

Technical: Microsoft Office, Google Workspace, Adobe Acrobat, JavaScript, TypeScript, React, AI/LLM integration